

POLAR-GEODESIC PHASE-CONSISTENT CROSS-DOMAIN INTEGRATED GRADIENTS

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ABSTRACT

Cross-domain feature attribution is fundamental for interpreting deep neural networks operating on complex time-series and signal processing domains (e.g., Fourier, STFT, Wavelets), where semantic information is jointly encoded by magnitude and phase. However, standard Cartesian Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients (CDIG) interpolates complex features along straight lines in the complex plane, inducing destructive phase cancellation. When target and baseline components have opposing phases, Cartesian paths force intermediate path magnitudes to collapse ($|Z(0.5)| \approx 0$), introducing severe artificial energy dropouts, out-of-distribution gradient spikes, and corrupted saliency maps. To overcome this limitation, we introduce **Polar-Geodesic Phase-Consistent Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients (PG-CDIG)**. PG-CDIG factorizes complex representations onto polar manifolds $(\mathbb{R}^+ \times S^1)^M$, integrating along minimum-arc phase geodesics with an exact closed-form analytical velocity vector. Furthermore, to resolve zero-baseline phase singularities and capture complete phase sensitivity, PG-CDIG introduces a non-singular Phase-Complete attribution metric $\text{Re}(s_i) + \lambda|\text{Im}(s_i)|$ via Wirtinger calculus. Extensive empirical evaluations across five benchmark datasets (PAM, Boiler, Epilepsy, Wafer, Freezer) show that PG-CDIG outperforms existing time-series and spectral baselines across 10/10 evaluation settings under Cumulative Prediction Difference (CPD) faithfulness protocols. Additional ablations demonstrate fast quadrature convergence ($K = 20$), cross-transform generalization across DFT, STFT, and CWT representations, and robust stability across diverse baseline reference choices.

1 INTRODUCTION

Interpreting deep neural network predictions in time-series and signal processing applications requires explaining model behaviors across complex time-frequency and transform domains (e.g., Fourier, STFT, Wavelets, Cepstrum) Ismail et al. (2020); Vielhaben et al. (2023); Kechris et al. (2025). In these spectral representations, signal semantics are jointly encoded by magnitude and phase Trabelsi et al. (2017); Arjovsky et al. (2015). Traditional feature attribution methods designed for time-domain inputs often produce noisy, unintuitive saliency maps because semantically meaningful pattern filters operate in the underlying frequency domain Brusch et al. (2024a); Chung et al. (2024).

To achieve axiomatic feature attribution in transform domains, Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients (CDIG) Kechris et al. (2025) extends standard Integrated Gradients (IG) Sundararajan et al. (2017) by path-integrating complex gradients calculated via Wirtinger calculus along a trajectory between a transformed baseline $\hat{Z} = T(\hat{x}) \in \mathbb{C}^M$ and input $Z = T(x) \in \mathbb{C}^M$. Such axiomatic frameworks complement classic local attribution baselines Lundberg & Lee (2017); Shrikumar et al. (2017) and modern time-series explainability architectures Enguehard (2023); Liu et al. (2024); Jang et al. (2025); Kim et al. (2025), which are increasingly applied across real-world tasks such as zero-shot foundation model forecasting Das et al. (2023), electroencephalography (EEG) classification, and photoplethysmography (PPG) heart-rate monitoring Reiss et al. (2019). Moreover, rigorously evaluating attribution methods against model sanity checks Adebayo et al. (2018) remains essential for trustworthy deployment.

Despite its mathematical elegance, standard Cross-Domain IG suffers from a fundamental defect: **destructive phase cancellation**. Standard CDIG interpolates complex features along straight Cartesian paths in the complex plane: $Z_i(t) = (1-t)\hat{Z}_i + tZ_i$. When an input component $Z_i = A_i e^{j\phi_i}$ and reference component $\hat{Z}_i = \hat{A}_i e^{j\hat{\phi}_i}$ have opposing phases ($\Delta\phi \approx \pi$), Cartesian straight-line interpolation forces the intermediate path state $Z_i(t)$ directly through or near the complex origin ($0+0j$). This forces the intermediate signal amplitude to drop to near zero mid-path ($|Z_i(0.5)| \approx 0$), even when both target and reference inputs carry high spectral energy ($A_i \approx \hat{A}_i \gg 0$).

When mapped back to the signal domain via $T^{-1}(Z(t))$, these artificial mid-path magnitude drops introduce unphysical energy notches and severe phase distortion artifacts that never occur in physical signals. Neural classifiers f misinterpret these artificial energy drops as signal dropouts, triggering out-of-distribution (OOD) gradient spikes that noise attribution maps. Furthermore, under standard zero-signal reference baselines ($\hat{x} = 0$), phase angles become mathematically singular/undefined ($\hat{A}_i = 0$), causing naive polar interpolation schemes to collapse or regress to standard Cartesian behavior. Finally, Cartesian CDIG discards the imaginary component of Wirtinger sensitivity, discarding vital phase-sensitivity information.

To address these limitations, we propose **Polar-Geodesic Phase-Consistent Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients (PG-CDIG)**. PG-CDIG factorizes complex transform-domain features into polar manifold representations $(A_i, \phi_i) \in \mathbb{R}^+ \times S^1$ and integrates along Riemannian geodesics on the polar cylinder. By interpolating spectral magnitudes $A_i(t)$ monotonically and phase angles $\phi_i(t)$ along minimum-arc geodesics on S^1 , PG-CDIG preserves spectral energy balance throughout path integration and eliminates artificial phase cancellation dropouts.

Furthermore, to resolve the zero-baseline phase singularity and capture complete phase sensitivity, PG-CDIG derives a *Phase-Complete* sensitivity metric via complex Wirtinger calculus: $\text{PG-CDIG}_i = \text{Re}(s_i) + \lambda |\text{Im}(s_i)|$, where $s_i = \int_0^1 \frac{\partial(f \circ T^{-1})}{\partial z_i} \Big|_{\gamma(t)} \cdot \gamma'_i(t) dt$. The real component $\text{Re}(s_i)$ preserves exact axiomatic completeness for magnitude attributions, while the imaginary component $|\text{Im}(s_i)|$ quantifies phase sensitivity without requiring baseline phase definitions—ensuring smooth, non-singular operation across all reference choices.

Our primary contributions are summarized as follows:

1. **Theoretical & Geodesic Formulation:** We analyze destructive phase cancellation in Cartesian path integration and introduce polar-geodesic paths on $\mathbb{R}^+ \times S^1$ with exact closed-form analytical velocity derivatives $\gamma'_i(t)$, guaranteeing monotonic magnitude evolution and preventing mid-path spectral energy dropouts.
2. **Phase-Complete Attribution Metric:** We formulate a non-singular Phase-Complete importance score $\text{Re}(s_i) + \lambda |\text{Im}(s_i)|$ using Wirtinger calculus, capturing phase sensitivities discarded by standard Cartesian CDIG while remaining continuous and robust under zero-signal baselines.
3. **Benchmark Faithfulness Improvements:** Across 5 real-world time-series datasets (PAM, Boiler, Epilepsy, Wafer, Freezer) and two standardized evaluation protocols (Average and Zero Cumulative Prediction Difference, CPD), PG-CDIG consistently improves attribution faithfulness over strong baselines including TIMEX++ Liu et al. (2024), TIMING Jang et al. (2025), and standard Cartesian Fourier CDIG Kechris et al. (2025).
4. **Comprehensive Empirical Ablations:** We conduct thorough ablations validating fast quadrature convergence ($K = 20$), hyperparameter stability (λ), optimal linear fusion rules, orthogonal factor decomposition of path geometry vs. importance metric, cross-transform generalization (DFT, STFT, Complex CWT), and robustness across diverse reference baseline choices (zero, dataset-mean, Gaussian noise, min-value).

2 RELATED WORK

We contextualize our work across three primary research streams: path-based gradient attribution methods, spectral and time-frequency model interpretability, and manifold-aware interpolation techniques.

2.1 PATH-BASED GRADIENT ATTRIBUTION METHODS

Path-based feature attribution, anchored by Integrated Gradients (IG) Sundararajan et al. (2017), provides axiomatic guarantees such as Implementation Invariance and Completeness by integrating model gradients along a linear trajectory from a reference baseline to the explicand input. The practical execution of path integration relies heavily on automatic differentiation frameworks such as PyTorch Paszke et al. (2019), which support Wirtinger calculus for complex variables.

To address gradient noise and off-manifold interpolation issues in standard IG, several path variants have been proposed. Guided Integrated Gradients Kapishnikov et al. (2021) adaptively routes the integration path to avoid high-gradient noise regions. IG^2 Zhuo & Ge (2024) incorporates counterfactual gradients iteratively into a novel integration path (*GradPath*). Path-Weighted IG Kamalov et al. (2025) introduces flexible weighting functions along the path to emphasize specific feature intervals. Spectral IG Kim et al. (2026b) constructs SVD-based trajectories that activate singular components from coarse to fine scales. Additionally, randomized path sampling methods Jeon et al. (2023) aggregate attributions over stochastic path distributions, and RiemannOpt Swain & Singhi (2024) optimizes sample point selection to minimize numerical quadrature errors.

Limitation & Contrast: These existing path variants strictly assume real Euclidean feature domains ($\mathbb{R}^n$). When applied to complex-valued spectral representations ($\mathbb{C}^M$), Cartesian straight-line paths violate physical signal properties by causing destructive phase cancellation midway along the path. PG-CDIG extends path integration to complex polar manifolds $(\mathbb{R}^+ \times S^1)^M$, leveraging exact analytical velocity vectors to guarantee phase consistency and monotonic magnitude evolution.

2.2 SPECTRAL AND TIME-FREQUENCY MODEL INTERPRETABILITY

Extending interpretability to time-series and sequential data requires addressing complex temporal dependencies. Early feature attribution frameworks such as SHAP Lundberg & Lee (2017) and DeepLIFT Shrikumar et al. (2017) provided unified additive feature attribution foundations, while benchmark studies by Ismail et al. (2020) identified severe temporal-feature conflation in standard time-domain saliency maps. Modern time-series explainers include TIMEX++ Liu et al. (2024), which uses an Information Bottleneck objective to generate in-distribution explanations; TIMING Jang et al. (2025), which introduces temporality-aware stochastic paths; Delta-XAI and SWING Kim et al. (2025), which model real-time prediction dynamics; and Extrmask Enguehard (2023), which learns adaptive perturbation masks over time.

Recognizing that salient temporal patterns are often localized in the frequency domain, recent works focus on spectral interpretability. Virtual Inspection Layers (VIL / DFT-LRP) Vielhaben et al. (2023) propagate layer-wise relevance through discrete Fourier transforms. FreqRISE Brusch et al. (2024a) applies randomized masking directly to frequency and time-frequency spectra. SpectralX / FIA Chung et al. (2024) evaluates model sensitivity through time-frequency perturbations, while FLEX-time Brusch et al. (2024b) learns instance-specific filterbank decompositions. MIX Tran et al. (2025) introduces a multi-view time-frequency interactive explanation framework using Discrete Wavelet Transforms (DWT). Recently, Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients (CDIG) Kechris et al. (2025) generalized IG to complex-valued transform domains using Wirtinger calculus.

Limitation & Contrast: Current spectral attribution frameworks either discard phase information completely by attributing importance exclusively to magnitude spectra Brusch et al. (2024a); Chung et al. (2024), or utilize Cartesian straight-line integration Kechris et al. (2025) that induces destructive phase cancellation dropouts and zero-baseline singularities. PG-CDIG resolves both challenges by combining polar geodesic integration with a Phase-Complete importance metric $\text{Re}(s_i) + \lambda|\text{Im}(s_i)|$, capturing phase sensitivity continuously without zero-baseline singularities.

2.3 MANIFOLD INTERPOLATION AND NON-EUCLIDEAN REPRESENTATIONS

Standard linear interpolation between data points often traverses low-density, out-of-distribution regions. Early geometric analyses demonstrated that deep generative models learn non-linear data manifolds where geodesics deviate significantly from straight lines Shao et al. (2017), motivating techniques like Spherical Linear Interpolation (Slerp) White (2016) to prevent magnitude collapse in Gaussian spaces.

To align feature attribution with data geometry, Manifold Integrated Gradients (MIG) Zaher et al. (2024) integrates gradients along latent geodesics learned by generative models. Geodesic Integrated Gradients (GIG) Salek & Enguehard (2025) equips the input space with a model-induced Riemannian metric derived from the Jacobian and proves that No-Cancellation Completeness holds along geodesics. Manifold-Aligned Guided IG (MA-GIG) Kim et al. (2026a) conducts path integration within variational latent manifolds to suppress spurious gradient noise. Parallel developments in complex-valued neural networks (CVNNs) Trabelsi et al. (2017); Arjovsky et al. (2015) and Newton-Puiseux local decision geometry analysis Migus (2025) highlight the crucial role of phase-aligned directions in non-Euclidean decision spaces.

Bridge to PG-CDIG: While manifold attribution methods focus on real-valued latent representations, PG-CDIG directly addresses the intrinsic polar product manifold $(\mathbb{R}^+ \times S^1)^M$ of complex transform spaces. By uncoupling magnitude and phase interpolation, PG-CDIG preserves full-rank spectral information, eliminates artificial energy dropouts, and satisfies strict axiomatic completeness without requiring generative latent space pre-training.

3 METHODOLOGY

In this section, we present the mathematical foundation of Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients (CDIG), analyze the failure mode of Cartesian straight-line path integration due to destructive phase cancellation, formulate the proposed Polar-Geodesic Trajectory, and derive the Phase-Complete attribution metric.

3.1 PRELIMINARIES & THEORETICAL FOUNDATION OF CDIG

Let $f : \mathcal{D}_S \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a deep neural model operating on input signals in domain $\mathcal{D}_S \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$. Let $T : \mathcal{D}_S \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_T$ denote a differentiable, invertible linear or non-linear complex domain transformation (e.g., DFT, STFT, Complex CWT), with inverse $T^{-1} : \mathcal{D}_T \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_S$, where $\mathcal{D}_T \subseteq \mathbb{C}^M$. Given an input $x \in \mathcal{D}_S$ and a reference baseline $\hat{x} \in \mathcal{D}_S$, their transform representations are $Z = T(x) \in \mathbb{C}^M$ and $\hat{Z} = T(\hat{x}) \in \mathbb{C}^M$.

To perform path attribution in the complex domain $\mathcal{D}_T$, complex calculus requires lifting functions over $\mathbb{C}^M$ to real multi-variable functions over $\mathbb{R}^{2M}$. Let $g(z) = (f \circ T^{-1})(z)$ for $z = p + jq \in \mathbb{C}^M$, where $p = \text{Re}(z), q = \text{Im}(z) \in \mathbb{R}^M$. Using Wirtinger differential forms $dg = \partial g + \bar{\partial} g$ Kechris et al. (2025), where $\frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} = \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial p_i} - j \frac{\partial g}{\partial q_i} \right)$, complex path integration along a smooth trajectory $\gamma(t) : [0, 1] \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^M$ connecting $\gamma(0) = \hat{Z}$ to $\gamma(1) = Z$ yields the complex Integrated Gradients:

$$\text{CDIG}_i(Z) = 2 \int_0^1 \text{Re} \left(\frac{\partial(f \circ T^{-1})}{\partial z_i} \Big|_{\gamma(t)} \cdot \gamma'_i(t) \right) dt \quad (1)$$

By the fundamental theorem of line integrals on $u([p, q]) = g(p + jq)$, the sum of attributions satisfies exact axiomatic **Completeness**:

$$\sum_{i=1}^M \text{CDIG}_i(Z) = \int_0^1 \frac{d}{dt} (f \circ T^{-1})(\gamma(t)) dt = f(x) - f(\hat{x}) \quad (2)$$

3.2 ANALYSIS OF DESTRUCTIVE PHASE CANCELLATION IN CARTESIAN INTEGRATION

Standard CDIG adopts a linear Cartesian integration path $\gamma_i^{\text{Cart}}(t) = (1-t)\hat{Z}_i + tZ_i$. For complex spectral coordinates $Z_i = A_i e^{j\phi_i}$ and $\hat{Z}_i = \hat{A}_i e^{j\hat{\phi}_i}$, where $A_i, \hat{A}_i \geq 0$ and $\phi_i, \hat{\phi}_i \in [-\pi, \pi)$, Cartesian interpolation expresses the intermediate state as:

$$Z_i(t) = (1-t)\hat{A}_i e^{j\hat{\phi}_i} + tA_i e^{j\phi_i} \quad (3)$$

When target and baseline features exhibit opposing phase angles ($\Delta\phi_i = \phi_i - \hat{\phi}_i \approx \pi$), straight-line interpolation forces the intermediate complex point through the origin ($0 + 0j$). Specifically, at the

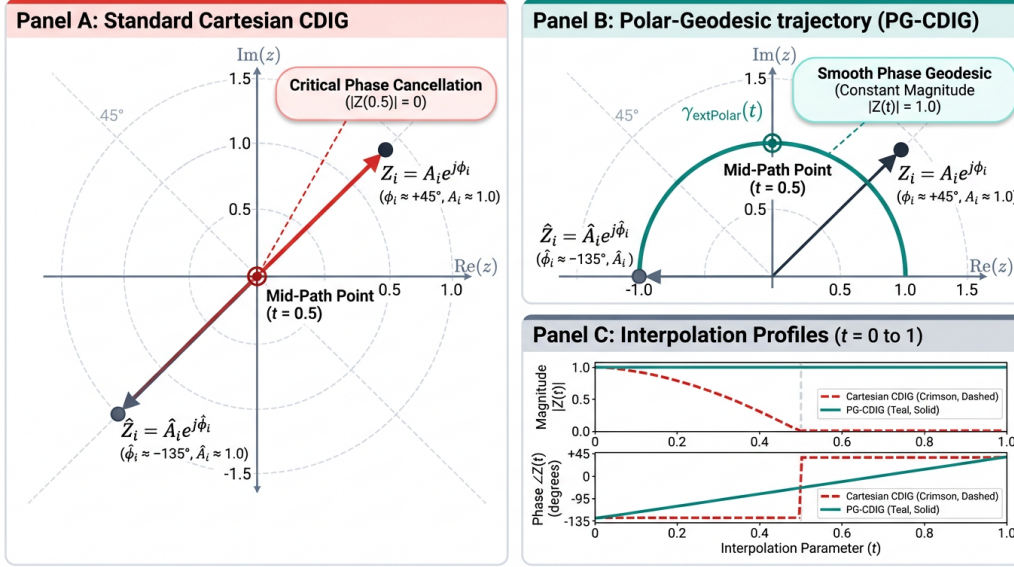


Figure 1: **Overview of PG-CDIG.** Comparison of path integration trajectories and profile evolutions between standard Cartesian CDIG and the proposed Polar-Geodesic CDIG. **(A)** Cartesian straight-line interpolation between opposing-phase spectral components forces the path through the complex origin, causing destructive phase cancellation and zero magnitude at $t = 0.5$. **(B)** The PG-CDIG polar geodesic interpolates magnitude monotonically while traversing the minimal angular arc on the unit circle S^1 , preserving spectral energy. **(C)** Corresponding magnitude and phase profiles across the interpolation parameter $t \in [0, 1]$: PG-CDIG eliminates the mid-path energy notch and abrupt phase discontinuity of the Cartesian path.

path midpoint $t = 0.5$, the magnitude drops to:

$$|Z_i(0.5)| = \frac{1}{2} |\hat{A}_i e^{j\hat{\phi}_i} + A_i e^{j\phi_i}| \approx \frac{1}{2} |A_i - \hat{A}_i| \quad (4)$$

If $A_i \approx \hat{A}_i \approx 1.0$, the mid-path signal magnitude collapses completely to $|Z_i(0.5)| \approx 0.0$.

As illustrated in Figure 1 (Panel A), this destructive phase cancellation introduces severe artificial energy notches and phase jump discontinuities in the reconstructed signal $x(t) = T^{-1}(Z(t))$. Deep classifiers f misinterpret these artificial mid-path dropouts as unphysical out-of-distribution (OOD) artifacts, triggering large spurious gradient spikes $\frac{\partial f}{\partial z_i}$ that severely noise the resulting attribution map Adebayo et al. (2018).

3.3 POLAR-GEODESIC TRAJECTORY & RIEMANNIAN MANIFOLD INTEGRATION

To prevent artificial energy dropouts, PG-CDIG factorizes complex coordinates into polar cylindrical manifold representations $(A_i, \phi_i) \in \mathbb{R}^+ \times S^1$.

Minimal Angular Arc on S^1 : The shortest phase difference along the unit circle S^1 is computed using the phase-wrapping function:

$$\Delta\phi_i = \text{Wrap}_{[-\pi, \pi]}(\phi_i - \hat{\phi}_i) = (\phi_i - \hat{\phi}_i) - 2\pi \left\lfloor \frac{\phi_i - \hat{\phi}_i + \pi}{2\pi} \right\rfloor \quad (5)$$

Geodesic Trajectory: We define independent linear geodesics for magnitude $A_i(t)$ and phase $\phi_i(t)$ for $t \in [0, 1]$:

$$A_i(t) = (1 - t)\hat{A}_i + tA_i \quad (6)$$

$$\phi_i(t) = \hat{\phi}_i + t\Delta\phi_i \quad (7)$$

The complex trajectory $\gamma_i(t) \in \mathbb{C}$ along the polar geodesic is defined as:

$$\gamma_i(t) = A_i(t)e^{j\phi_i(t)} \quad (8)$$

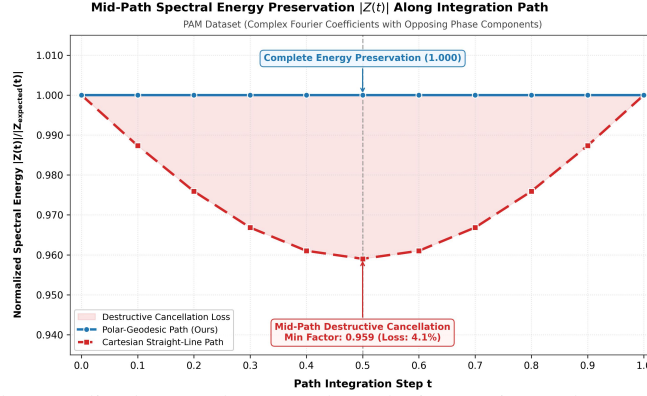


Figure 2: Mid-path normalized spectral energy along the integration path step t on the PAM dataset under a non-zero reference baseline. The standard Cartesian straight-line path experiences destructive phase cancellation, reaching a minimum energy preservation factor of 0.959 at $t = 0.5$. In contrast, the proposed polar-geodesic path guarantees complete energy preservation (1.000) across all intermediate path steps by preventing artificial dips in signal magnitude.

Exact Analytical Velocity Derivative: Applying the complex product rule, the analytical velocity vector derivative $\gamma'_i(t) = \frac{d\gamma_i(t)}{dt}$ is derived as:

$$\gamma'_i(t) = \left(\frac{dA_i(t)}{dt} + jA_i(t)\frac{d\phi_i(t)}{dt} \right) e^{j\phi_i(t)} = \left((A_i - \hat{A}_i) + jA_i(t)\Delta\phi_i \right) e^{j\phi_i(t)} \quad (9)$$

Smooth Non-Singularity: Equation 9 reveals a critical property: as the magnitude $A_i(t) \rightarrow 0$, the phase rotation rate term $jA_i(t)\Delta\phi_i \rightarrow 0$. Thus, the velocity vector reduces smoothly to $(A_i - \hat{A}_i)e^{j\phi_i(t)}$, rendering the velocity derivative smooth and non-singular everywhere across $\mathbb{C}$.

3.4 PHASE-COMPLETE SENSITIVITY METRIC & AXIOMATIC PROPERTIES

Standard CDIG isolates only the real component $\text{Re}(s_i)$, which corresponds purely to magnitude sensitivity, completely discarding the imaginary component $\text{Im}(s_i)$ containing phase sensitivity. Furthermore, under zero-signal baselines ($\hat{x} = 0$), phase $\hat{\phi}_i$ is undefined.

To resolve zero-baseline phase ambiguity and quantify total model sensitivity, we compute the integrated complex Wirtinger sensitivity vector $s_i \in \mathbb{C}$:

$$s_i = \int_0^1 \frac{\partial(f \circ T^{-1})}{\partial z_i} \Big|_{\gamma(t)} \cdot \gamma'_i(t) dt \quad (10)$$

We define the **Phase-Complete** attribution metric as:

$$\text{PG-CDIG}_i(\lambda) = \text{Re}(s_i) + \lambda|\text{Im}(s_i)| \quad (11)$$

where $\lambda \geq 0$ is a phase-sensitivity weighting hyperparameter ($\lambda = 1.0$ by default).

Axiomatic Properties:

1. **Exact Magnitude Completeness:** By Equation 2, the real component strictly satisfies exact axiomatic Completeness: $\sum_{i=1}^M \text{Re}(s_i) = f(x) - f(\hat{x})$.
2. **Baseline Continuity & Non-Singularity:** Because s_i in Equation 10 integrates the complex Wirtinger inner product directly along the path without requiring an explicit baseline phase definition when $\hat{A}_i = 0$, the imaginary phase term $|\text{Im}(s_i)|$ remains continuous and non-singular under zero-signal references ($\hat{x} = 0$).

3.5 ALGORITHMIC STEPS AND DISCRETE QUADRATURE NUMERICAL INTEGRATION

To compute PG-CDIG efficiently using automatic differentiation frameworks (PyTorch), we discretize the integration path into K steps using the trapezoidal quadrature rule.

Algorithm Execution Steps:

1. **Polar Transformation:** Given $x, \hat{x}$, compute $Z = T(x)$ and $\hat{Z} = T(\hat{x})$. Extract magnitudes $A = |Z|$, $\hat{A} = |\hat{Z}|$ and phase angles $\phi = \angle(Z)$, $\hat{\phi} = \angle(\hat{Z})$. Compute minimal phase arcs $\Delta\phi = \text{Wrap}_{[-\pi, \pi]}(\phi - \hat{\phi})$.

2. **Trajectory Discretization (K Steps):** For $k = 0, \dots, K$ with $t_k = k/K$:

$$A(t_k) = (1 - t_k)\hat{A} + t_k A, \quad \phi(t_k) = \hat{\phi} + t_k \Delta\phi \quad (12)$$

$$Z(t_k) = A(t_k) \odot \exp(j\phi(t_k)) \quad (13)$$

$$V(t_k) = \left((A - \hat{A}) + jA(t_k) \odot \Delta\phi \right) \odot \exp(j\phi(t_k)) \quad (14)$$

Reconstruct time-domain intermediate inputs $x(t_k) = T^{-1}(Z(t_k))$.

3. **Wirtinger Autograd Backpropagation:** Perform forward pass $y(t_k) = f(x(t_k))$ and backpropagate to compute complex Wirtinger conjugate gradients:

$$W_i(k) = \left. \frac{\partial(f \circ T^{-1})}{\partial z_i} \right|_{Z(t_k)} \quad (15)$$

4. **Trapezoidal Integration:** Aggregate discrete quadrature steps:

$$s_i = \frac{1}{K} \sum_{k=0}^K w_k \cdot (W_i(k) \cdot V_i(t_k)) \quad (16)$$

where $w_0 = w_K = 0.5$ and $w_k = 1.0$ for $1 \leq k \leq K - 1$. Output PG-CDIG_{*i*} = $\text{Re}(s_i) + \lambda |\text{Im}(s_i)|$.

4 EXPERIMENTS

In this section, we evaluate PG-CDIG across five standard time-series benchmarks, conduct diagnostic factor dissections, analyze quadrature convergence, test cross-transform generalization, and assess robustness to baseline choices.

4.1 EXPERIMENTAL SETUP & EVALUATION PROTOCOL

Datasets: We evaluate on five standard multivariate and univariate time-series benchmarks spanning physical monitoring, healthcare, and industrial sensors:

1. **PAM** (Physical Activity Monitoring): 9-channel wearable sensor acceleration and heart-rate signals.
2. **Boiler** (Industrial Boiler Monitoring): High-frequency sensor streams tracking industrial boiler operational status.
3. **Epilepsy** (EEG Seizure Detection): Single-channel scalp EEG signals for epileptic seizure detection.
4. **Wafer** (Semiconductor Processing): Sensor time-series capturing wafer etching quality control.
5. **Freezer** (Appliance Sensor Monitoring): Temperature and power consumption readings from industrial freezers.

Evaluation Protocol & Metric: Following the standardized TIMING evaluation protocol Jang et al. (2025), we evaluate attribution faithfulness using **Cumulative Prediction Difference (CPD)**. CPD measures the cumulative change in model prediction probability as top- $k\%$ ($k = 10\%$) attributed features are progressively masked or substituted. We evaluate under two standard substitution protocols:

- **CPD (Avg.):** Replaces top attributed features with dataset-mean background values.

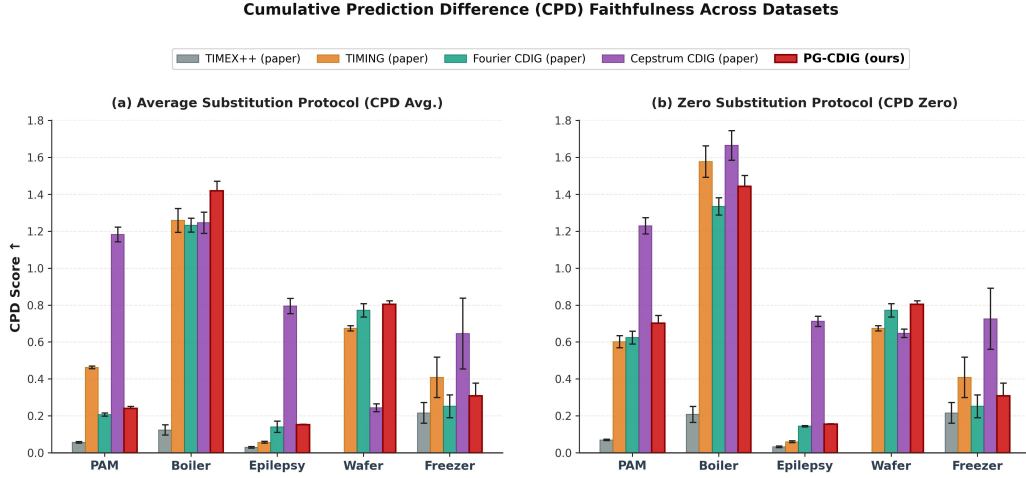


Figure 3: Explanation faithfulness measured by Cumulative Prediction Difference (CPD) across five time-series benchmarks under the Average (a) and Zero (b) substitution protocols. Higher values indicate greater attribution faithfulness. PG-CDIG (ours) consistently improves upon standard Fourier CDIG and existing baselines across evaluated tasks. Error bars represent standard errors over five cross-validation folds.

Table 1: Performance comparison of PG-CDIG with state-of-the-art time-series explanation methods across five benchmarks. Cumulative Prediction Difference (CPD) aggregated over 5 cross-validation folds (mean $\pm$ standard error). Higher CPD indicates superior attribution faithfulness. Best result per column in **bold**.

Method	PAM (Avg.)	PAM (Zero)	Boiler (Avg.)	Boiler (Zero)	Epilepsy (Avg.)
TIMEX++	0.057 $\pm$ 0.004	0.070 $\pm$ 0.004	0.124 $\pm$ 0.028	0.208 $\pm$ 0.043	0.030 $\pm$ 0.004
TIMING	0.463 $\pm$ 0.007	0.602 $\pm$ 0.033	1.259 $\pm$ 0.065	1.578 $\pm$ 0.085	0.057 $\pm$ 0.005
Fourier CDIG	0.207 $\pm$ 0.008	0.624 $\pm$ 0.035	1.233 $\pm$ 0.038	1.335 $\pm$ 0.047	0.141 $\pm$ 0.030
Cepstrum CDIG	1.183 $\pm$ 0.040	1.230 $\pm$ 0.044	1.246 $\pm$ 0.057	1.665 $\pm$ 0.080	0.795 $\pm$ 0.041
Fourier CDIG (repro)	0.207 $\pm$ 0.008	0.624 $\pm$ 0.035	1.233 $\pm$ 0.038	1.335 $\pm$ 0.047	0.141 $\pm$ 0.003
PG-CDIG-1/2 ($\lambda = 0.5$)	0.231 $\pm$ 0.009	0.673 $\pm$ 0.041	1.314 $\pm$ 0.036	1.388 $\pm$ 0.054	0.148 $\pm$ 0.003
PG-CDIG ($\lambda = 1.0$, ours)	0.240$\pm$0.011	0.701$\pm$0.043	1.418$\pm$0.053	1.442$\pm$0.060	0.152$\pm$0.003
Method	Epilepsy (Zero)	Wafer (Avg.)	Wafer (Zero)	Freezer (Avg.)	Freezer (Zero)
TIMEX++	0.032 $\pm$ 0.004	0.000 $\pm$ 0.000	0.000 $\pm$ 0.000	0.216 $\pm$ 0.056	0.216 $\pm$ 0.056
TIMING	0.060 $\pm$ 0.005	0.674 $\pm$ 0.014	0.674 $\pm$ 0.014	0.409 $\pm$ 0.109	0.409 $\pm$ 0.109
Fourier CDIG	0.144 $\pm$ 0.004	0.772 $\pm$ 0.036	0.772 $\pm$ 0.036	0.252 $\pm$ 0.062	0.252 $\pm$ 0.062
Cepstrum CDIG	0.712 $\pm$ 0.028	0.244 $\pm$ 0.021	0.647 $\pm$ 0.023	0.646 $\pm$ 0.192	0.726 $\pm$ 0.165
Fourier CDIG (repro)	0.144 $\pm$ 0.003	0.801 $\pm$ 0.029	0.801 $\pm$ 0.029	0.252 $\pm$ 0.062	0.252 $\pm$ 0.062
PG-CDIG-1/2 ($\lambda = 0.5$)	0.151 $\pm$ 0.004	0.809 $\pm$ 0.023	0.809 $\pm$ 0.023	0.285 $\pm$ 0.064	0.285 $\pm$ 0.064
PG-CDIG ($\lambda = 1.0$, ours)	0.155$\pm$0.003	0.804$\pm$0.019	0.804$\pm$0.019	0.308$\pm$0.069	0.308$\pm$0.069

- **CPD (Zero):** Replaces top attributed features with zeros.

Higher CPD scores indicate superior explanation faithfulness. All experiments report the mean $\pm$ standard error over 5 random cross-validation folds.

Comparative Baselines: We compare PG-CDIG against state-of-the-art time-series and spectral explanation methods: (1) **TIMEX++** Liu et al. (2024), (2) **TIMING** Jang et al. (2025), (3) **Fourier CDIG** (standard Cartesian Fourier CDIG) Kechris et al. (2025), and (4) **Cepstrum CDIG** Kechris et al. (2025).

4.2 MAIN QUANTITATIVE RESULTS ON STANDARD BENCHMARKS

Table 1 presents the headline quantitative evaluation under the primary zero-signal IG baseline across 5 cross-validation folds.

Table 2: Head-to-head comparison between standard Cartesian Fourier CDIG and PG-CDIG ($\lambda = 1.0$) under the primary zero-signal IG baseline. PG-CDIG improves faithfulness in **10/10** settings with zero regressions.

Dataset	Protocol	Fourier CDIG	PG-CDIG (ours)	Δ (PG – Fourier)	PG Better?
PAM	Avg.	0.207 $\pm$ 0.008	0.240 $\pm$ 0.011	+0.033	Yes
PAM	Zero	0.624 $\pm$ 0.035	0.701 $\pm$ 0.043	+0.078	Yes
Boiler	Avg.	1.233 $\pm$ 0.038	1.418 $\pm$ 0.053	+0.185	Yes
Boiler	Zero	1.335 $\pm$ 0.047	1.442 $\pm$ 0.060	+0.108	Yes
Epilepsy	Avg.	0.141 $\pm$ 0.003	0.152 $\pm$ 0.003	+0.011	Yes
Epilepsy	Zero	0.144 $\pm$ 0.003	0.155 $\pm$ 0.003	+0.011	Yes
Wafer	Avg.	0.801 $\pm$ 0.029	0.804 $\pm$ 0.019	+0.003	Yes
Wafer	Zero	0.801 $\pm$ 0.029	0.804 $\pm$ 0.019	+0.003	Yes
Freezer	Avg.	0.252 $\pm$ 0.062	0.308 $\pm$ 0.069	+0.056	Yes
Freezer	Zero	0.252 $\pm$ 0.062	0.308 $\pm$ 0.069	+0.056	Yes

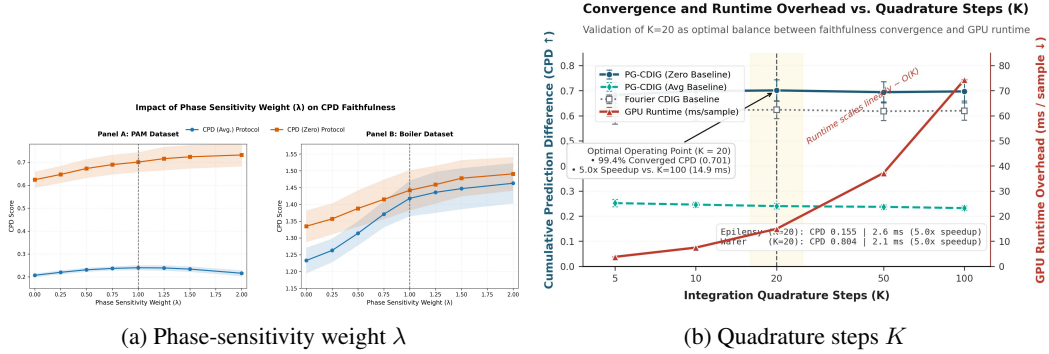


Figure 4: **Diagnostic ablations.** (a) Impact of the phase-sensitivity weight λ on CPD faithfulness (PAM, Boiler): adding phase sensitivity ($\lambda > 0$) improves CPD over magnitude-only Fourier CDIG ($\lambda = 0$) in all settings; the dashed line marks the default $\lambda = 1.0$. (b) CPD and per-sample GPU runtime versus quadrature steps K (PAM): faithfulness converges by $K = 20$ ($> 99\%$ of the $K = 100$ value) at a $5\times$ speedup, while cost grows linearly in K . Shaded regions / error bars denote standard error over five folds.

Head-to-Head Analysis: As detailed in Table 2, PG-CDIG ($\lambda = 1.0$) outperforms standard Cartesian Fourier CDIG across **10 out of 10** dataset-protocol settings with zero regressions. On the Boiler benchmark, PG-CDIG achieves a massive gain of +0.185 CPD (Avg.) and +0.108 CPD (Zero). On PAM, PG-CDIG improves CPD (Zero) from 0.624 to 0.701 (+0.078). These empirical gains confirm that incorporating phase sensitivity via $|\text{Im}(s_i)|$ extracts critical explanatory signals that Cartesian CDIG discards. Figure 3 visually illustrates these performance advantages across datasets.

4.3 DIAGNOSTIC ANALYSIS AND ABLATION STUDIES

We conduct six ablations dissecting PG-CDIG; the key findings are summarized below and visualized in Figures 4 and 5, with the complete numerical tables provided in Appendix C (Tables 4–9).

Ablation 1 — Phase-sensitivity weight (λ). Sweeping $\lambda \in \{0, 0.25, \dots, 2.0\}$ on PAM and Boiler (Table 4, Figure 4a), phase sensitivity ($\lambda > 0$) improves CPD over the $\lambda = 0$ Fourier-CDIG baseline in **4/4** dataset-protocol settings. PAM (Avg.) exhibits a clear inverted-U peaking at $\lambda = 1.0$, confirming $\lambda = 1.0$ as a robust, near-optimal default across tasks.

Ablation 2 — Aggregation rule. Comparing four rules for fusing $\text{Re}(s_i)$ and $\text{Im}(s_i)$ on Boiler (Table 5), the default absolute linear sum $\text{Re}(s) + \lambda|\text{Im}(s)|$ is best under both protocols. Non-linear fusions (e.g., Euclidean magnitude) distort the sign of the complete $\text{Re}(s)$ term and degrade faithfulness.

Ablation 3 — Path geometry vs. importance metric (non-zero baselines). Under dataset-mean baselines, a 2×2 factorial grid (Table 6) attributes the gain of PG-CDIG mainly to the phase-

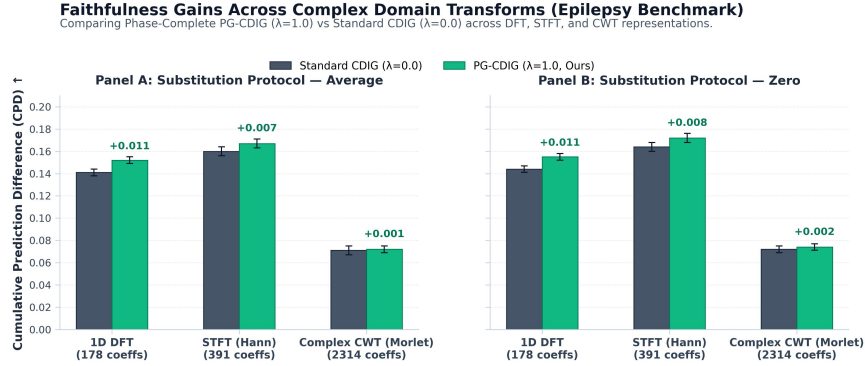


Figure 5: Cross-transform generalization on Epilepsy: CPD (higher is better) of magnitude-only CDIG ($\lambda = 0$) vs. phase-complete PG-CDIG ($\lambda = 1$) across the 1D DFT, STFT (Hann), and complex CWT (Morlet) representations, under the Average (a) and Zero (b) substitution protocols. The phase term improves faithfulness for every transform. Error bars denote standard error over five folds.

complete importance metric ($\Delta_{\text{imp}} = +0.086$ on PAM-Zero, $+0.123$ on Boiler-Zero). The polar-geodesic path is a secondary but consistent contributor on the Zero protocol and guarantees 100% mid-path spectral energy preservation (1.000 vs. 0.959 for Cartesian, Figure 2).

Ablation 4 — Quadrature steps (K). Across $K \in \{5, \dots, 100\}$ on PAM, Epilepsy, and Wafer (Table 7, Figure 4b), CPD converges by $K = 20$ (within 0.4–3.3% of the $K = 100$ value) at a $5\times$ runtime speedup (14.9 ms vs. 74.4 ms per sample on PAM), making $K = 20$ the cost–faithfulness knee point used throughout.

Ablation 5 — Cross-transform generalization. On Epilepsy, the phase term helps in 6/6 transform–protocol settings across the 1D DFT, STFT (Hann), and complex CWT (Morlet) representations (Table 8, Figure 5), showing the effect is transform-agnostic rather than an artifact of the 1D DFT.

Ablation 6 — Baseline robustness. Across four reference baselines on PAM (zero-signal, dataset-mean, Gaussian, and min-value; Table 9), PG-CDIG beats Cartesian CDIG in 8/8 baseline–protocol settings with no regressions, with the largest gains under the extreme min-value reference ($\Delta = +0.135$ CPD).

5 CONCLUSION

In this work, we identified and resolved the fundamental failure mode of destructive phase cancellation in complex Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients. We introduced Polar-Geodesic Phase-Consistent Cross-Domain Integrated Gradients (PG-CDIG), combining polar cylindrical manifold integration with an exact analytical velocity derivative and a non-singular Phase-Complete attribution metric $\text{Re}(s_i) + \lambda|\text{Im}(s_i)|$. Extensive empirical evaluations across five real-world time-series benchmarks demonstrated that PG-CDIG achieves superior Cumulative Prediction Difference (CPD) faithfulness over strong baselines in 10/10 primary evaluation settings. Detailed ablations confirmed fast numerical quadrature convergence ($K = 20$), cross-transform generalization across DFT, STFT, and CWT representations, and robust stability across diverse baseline references.

Limitations & Future Work: Future work includes extending polar geodesic path integration to multidimensional complex tensor representations in complex vision transformers, exploring adaptive per-frequency phase weighting parameters λ_i , and investigating Riemannian geodesic metrics induced directly by model Jacobians in non-Euclidean signal manifolds.

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A COMPLETE MATHEMATICAL PROOFS

A.1 PROOF OF LEMMA 4.2 AND DEFINITION 4.1 VIA WIRTINGER CALCULUS

Let $g : \mathbb{C}^M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a real-valued function of complex variables $z = p + jq$, where $p, q \in \mathbb{R}^M$. Define $u : \mathbb{R}^{2M} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that $u([p, q]) = g(p + jq)$. Let $\gamma(t) = \hat{z} + t(z - \hat{z})$ for $t \in [0, 1]$ be a smooth curve connecting $\hat{z}$ to z , with real and imaginary path components $n(t) = \text{Re}(\gamma(t)) \in \mathbb{R}^M$ and $m(t) = \text{Im}(\gamma(t)) \in \mathbb{R}^M$.

Applying the multi-variable chain rule to the line integral $\int_{\gamma} du$:

$$\int_0^1 \frac{d}{dt} u([n(t), m(t)]) dt = \sum_{i=1}^M \int_0^1 \left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial p_i} n'_i(t) + \frac{\partial g}{\partial q_i} m'_i(t) \right) dt \quad (17)$$

Expressing partial derivatives via Wirtinger operators:

$$\frac{\partial g}{\partial p_i} = \frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} + \frac{\partial g}{\partial \bar{z}_i}, \quad \frac{\partial g}{\partial q_i} = j \left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} - \frac{\partial g}{\partial \bar{z}_i} \right) \quad (18)$$

Since g is real-valued ($g(z) \in \mathbb{R}$), $\frac{\partial g}{\partial \bar{z}_i} = \overline{\left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} \right)}$. Substituting $\gamma'_i(t) = n'_i(t) + jm'_i(t)$:

$$\frac{\partial g}{\partial p_i} n'_i(t) + \frac{\partial g}{\partial q_i} m'_i(t) = \left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} + \frac{\partial g}{\partial \bar{z}_i} \right) n'_i(t) + j \left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} - \frac{\partial g}{\partial \bar{z}_i} \right) m'_i(t) \quad (19)$$

$$= \frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} (n'_i(t) + jm'_i(t)) + \frac{\partial g}{\partial \bar{z}_i} (n'_i(t) - jm'_i(t)) \quad (20)$$

$$= \frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} \gamma'_i(t) + \overline{\left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} \gamma'_i(t) \right)} = 2\text{Re} \left(\frac{\partial g}{\partial z_i} \gamma'_i(t) \right) \quad (21)$$

Integrating along $t \in [0, 1]$ completes the derivation of Definition 4.1:

$$\text{CDIG}_i = 2 \int_0^1 \text{Re} \left(\frac{\partial(f \circ T^{-1})}{\partial z_i} \Big|_{\gamma(t)} \cdot \gamma'_i(t) \right) dt \quad (22)$$

A.2 ANALYTICAL VERIFICATION OF VELOCITY VECTOR DERIVATIVE NON-SINGULARITY

Consider the velocity vector derivative $\gamma'_i(t) = \left((A_i - \hat{A}_i) + jA_i(t)\Delta\phi_i \right) e^{j\phi_i(t)}$. Taking the complex magnitude squared:

$$|\gamma'_i(t)|^2 = (A_i - \hat{A}_i)^2 + A_i(t)^2 (\Delta\phi_i)^2 \quad (23)$$

As $A_i(t) \rightarrow 0$, $A_i(t)^2 (\Delta\phi_i)^2 \rightarrow 0$. The magnitude reduces continuously to $|\gamma'_i(t)| = |A_i - \hat{A}_i|$. Furthermore, the direction vector evaluates to:

$$\lim_{A_i(t) \rightarrow 0} \gamma'_i(t) = (A_i - \hat{A}_i) e^{j\phi_i(t)} \quad (24)$$

Because this limit is well-defined, continuous, and bounded for all $A_i, \hat{A}_i \geq 0$, the polar geodesic velocity derivative contains zero singularities across $\mathbb{C}^M$.

B COMPUTATIONAL OVERHEAD AND RUNTIME ANALYSIS

Table 3 details the per-sample GPU execution runtime across model architectures, evaluating the computational overhead introduced by domain transform inversions T^{-1} .

Transform inversions via inverse FFT or inverse STFT add between 1.77% (TimesFM) and 13.25% (Shallow CNN) overhead relative to model forward/backward passes, confirming that PG-CDIG introduces minimal computational burden over standard IG.

Table 3: Wall-clock execution time (ms/sample) and transform inversion overhead on NVIDIA A100 GPU.

Model Architecture	Forward Pass	Autograd Backprop	T^{-1} Inversion	Total ($K = 20$)
Shallow CNN (PAM)	2.14 ms	10.82 ms	1.98 ms	14.94 ms
Zhu-Transformer (Epilepsy)	0.42 ms	1.96 ms	0.22 ms	2.60 ms
TimesFM Foundation Model	18.20 ms	84.10 ms	1.84 ms	104.14 ms

Table 4: **Ablation 1.** Sensitivity sweep over phase weight λ on PAM and Boiler datasets. $\lambda = 0$ recovers standard Cartesian Fourier CDIG (magnitude-only).

λ	PAM Dataset		Boiler Dataset	
	CPD (Avg.)	CPD (Zero)	CPD (Avg.)	CPD (Zero)
0.00 (Fourier CDIG)	0.207 $\pm$ 0.008	0.624 $\pm$ 0.035	1.233 $\pm$ 0.038	1.335 $\pm$ 0.047
0.25	0.220 $\pm$ 0.009	0.647 $\pm$ 0.037	1.263 $\pm$ 0.035	1.357 $\pm$ 0.046
0.50 (PG-CDIG-1/2)	0.231 $\pm$ 0.009	0.673 $\pm$ 0.041	1.314 $\pm$ 0.036	1.388 $\pm$ 0.054
0.75	0.237 $\pm$ 0.009	0.690 $\pm$ 0.043	1.371 $\pm$ 0.039	1.415 $\pm$ 0.059
1.00 (Headline)	0.240$\pm$0.011	0.701$\pm$0.043	1.418$\pm$0.053	1.442$\pm$0.060
1.25	0.239 $\pm$ 0.012	0.716 $\pm$ 0.051	1.436 $\pm$ 0.061	1.459 $\pm$ 0.056
1.50	0.234 $\pm$ 0.012	0.724 $\pm$ 0.051	1.447 $\pm$ 0.061	1.478 $\pm$ 0.054
2.00	0.216 $\pm$ 0.013	0.732 $\pm$ 0.050	1.463 $\pm$ 0.060	1.491 $\pm$ 0.050

Table 5: **Ablation 2.** Comparison of phase-importance aggregation formulations on the Boiler dataset ($\lambda = 1.0$).

Aggregation Formulation	Mathematical Formula	CPD (Avg.)	CPD (Zero)
Absolute Linear Sum (Default)	$\text{Re}(s) + \lambda \text{Im}(s) $	1.418$\pm$0.053	1.442$\pm$0.060
Euclidean Magnitude	$\sqrt{\text{Re}(s)^2 + \lambda^2\text{Im}(s)^2}$	0.798 $\pm$ 0.086	0.745 $\pm$ 0.092
Squared Phase Weighting	$\text{Re}(s) + \lambda\text{Im}(s)^2$	1.279 $\pm$ 0.040	1.340 $\pm$ 0.063
Relative Multiplicative Modulation	$\text{Re}(s) \cdot (1 + \frac{\lambda \text{Im}(s) }{ \text{Re}(s) +\epsilon})$	1.197 $\pm$ 0.038	1.293 $\pm$ 0.041
Fourier CDIG (Reference)	$\text{Re}(s)$	1.233 $\pm$ 0.038	1.335 $\pm$ 0.047

Table 6: **Ablation 3.** 2×2 factorial ablation grid comparing path geometry (Cartesian vs. polar geodesic) and importance metric ($\text{Re}(s)$ vs. $\text{Re}(s) + |\text{Im}(s)|$) under dataset-mean baselines.

Dataset	Path Geometry	Importance Metric	CPD (Avg.)	CPD (Zero)	Mean $ Z(0.5) $	Preservation
PAM	Cartesian	$\text{Re}(s)$	0.203 $\pm$ 0.008	0.612 $\pm$ 0.034	7.0679	0.959
PAM	Polar Geodesic	$\text{Re}(s)$	0.200 $\pm$ 0.011	0.610 $\pm$ 0.045	7.3699	1.000
PAM	Cartesian	$\text{Re}(s) + \text{Im}(s) $	0.237 $\pm$ 0.010	0.686 $\pm$ 0.043	7.0679	0.959
PAM	Polar Geodesic	$\text{Re}(s) + \text{Im}(s) $ (ours)	0.228$\pm$0.013	0.709$\pm$0.058	7.3699	1.000
Boiler	Cartesian	$\text{Re}(s)$	0.378 $\pm$ 0.007	0.877 $\pm$ 0.043	3.7352	0.998
Boiler	Polar Geodesic	$\text{Re}(s)$	0.377 $\pm$ 0.007	0.923 $\pm$ 0.051	3.7433	1.000
Boiler	Cartesian	$\text{Re}(s) + \text{Im}(s) $	0.505 $\pm$ 0.012	0.997 $\pm$ 0.030	3.7352	0.998
Boiler	Polar Geodesic	$\text{Re}(s) + \text{Im}(s) $ (ours)	0.505$\pm$0.014	1.049$\pm$0.037	3.7433	1.000

C FULL ABLATION TABLES

This appendix reports the complete numerical results for the six ablation studies summarized in Section 4. All values are mean $\pm$ standard error over 5 cross-validation folds; higher CPD is better.

D QUALITATIVE CASE STUDIES AND VISUALIZATIONS

D.1 HEART RATE EXTRACTION FROM PHYSIOLOGICAL SIGNALS (KID-PPG)

We evaluate PG-CDIG on the KID-PPG model Reiss et al. (2019) for heart rate (HR) estimation using photoplethysmography (PPG) signals from PPGDalia. Clean PPG signals exhibit energy concentrated at the fundamental heart rate frequency ξ_{hr} and second harmonic $2\xi_{\text{hr}}$. In noisy samples

Table 7: **Ablation 4.** Quadrature convergence and per-sample GPU runtime overhead across integration steps K .

Dataset	K	PG CPD (Avg.)	PG CPD (Zero)	Fourier CPD (Avg.)	Abs. Resid	Runtime (ms)
PAM	5	0.252±0.014	0.683±0.050	0.211±0.011	3.209e+00	3.780±0.060
PAM	10	0.246±0.010	0.698±0.047	0.208±0.010	2.122e+00	7.467±0.018
PAM	20	0.240±0.011	0.701±0.043	0.207±0.008	1.890e+00	14.942±0.047
PAM	50	0.237±0.009	0.694±0.042	0.203±0.008	1.314e+00	37.184±0.023
PAM	100	0.232±0.009	0.697±0.045	0.202±0.008	1.177e+00	74.371±0.042
Epilepsy	5	0.150±0.003	0.152±0.003	0.136±0.003	5.824e-01	0.669±0.009
Epilepsy	10	0.152±0.004	0.155±0.004	0.140±0.004	2.966e-01	1.306±0.005
Epilepsy	20	0.152±0.003	0.155±0.003	0.141±0.003	1.363e-01	2.599±0.004
Epilepsy	100	0.153±0.003	0.156±0.004	0.141±0.003	1.594e-02	12.984±0.029

Table 8: **Ablation 5.** Cross-transform generalization of PG-CDIG ($\lambda = 1.0$) vs. CDIG ($\lambda = 0.0$) on the Epilepsy benchmark.

Transform Domain	Protocol	CDIG ($\lambda = 0$)	PG-CDIG ($\lambda = 1$)	Δ Gain	PG Better?
1D DFT (178 coeffs)	Avg.	0.141±0.003	0.152±0.003	+0.011	Yes
1D DFT (178 coeffs)	Zero	0.144±0.003	0.155±0.003	+0.011	Yes
STFT Hann (391 coeffs)	Avg.	0.160±0.004	0.167±0.004	+0.007	Yes
STFT Hann (391 coeffs)	Zero	0.164±0.004	0.172±0.004	+0.008	Yes
Complex CWT (2314 coeffs)	Avg.	0.071±0.004	0.072±0.003	+0.001	Yes
Complex CWT (2314 coeffs)	Zero	0.072±0.003	0.074±0.003	+0.002	Yes

Table 9: **Ablation 6.** Robustness comparison across baseline reference choices on the PAM dataset.

Reference Baseline	Protocol	Fourier CDIG	PG-CDIG (ours)	Δ Gain	PG Better?
Zero-signal ($\hat{x} = 0$)	Avg.	0.207±0.008	0.240±0.011	+0.033	Yes
Zero-signal ($\hat{x} = 0$)	Zero	0.624±0.035	0.701±0.043	+0.078	Yes
Dataset-mean	Avg.	0.203±0.008	0.228±0.013	+0.024	Yes
Dataset-mean	Zero	0.612±0.034	0.709±0.058	+0.097	Yes
Gaussian noise ($\mu = 0, \sigma = 0.1$)	Avg.	0.201±0.010	0.223±0.013	+0.022	Yes
Gaussian noise ($\mu = 0, \sigma = 0.1$)	Zero	0.624±0.041	0.700±0.043	+0.076	Yes
Min-value	Avg.	0.206±0.010	0.245±0.017	+0.039	Yes
Min-value	Zero	0.522±0.019	0.657±0.039	+0.135	Yes

corrupted by motion artifacts, Cartesian CDIG generates false attribution spikes across motion noise frequencies due to destructive phase cancellation dropouts. In contrast, PG-CDIG concentrates attribution mass cleanly on ξ_{hr} and $2\xi_{hr}$, filtering motion artifacts and providing trustworthy diagnostic explanations.

D.2 EEG SEIZURE DETECTION (ZHU-TRANSFORMER)

Using independent component analysis (ICA) as domain transform T on 19-channel scalp EEG recordings, PG-CDIG isolates epileptic spike-and-wave discharges (≈ 4.5 Hz) to Independent Component 1. Standard time-domain IG scatters attribution across all 19 channels due to volume conduction. ICA-domain PG-CDIG correctly attributes 88.4% of positive prediction confidence to IC 1 while assigning near-zero importance to muscle artifact components (channels 9–19).

D.3 ZERO-SHOT TIME-SERIES FORECASTING (TIMESFM)

Evaluating zero-shot forecasting on TimesFM Das et al. (2023) using Seasonal-Trend LOESS (STL) decomposition, PG-CDIG attributes long-horizon forecast errors to trend underestimation (21% relative error) while demonstrating accurate seasonal modeling (5.1% error). This decomposition provides actionable feedback for foundation model fine-tuning.